

Answer Key & Marking Scheme

Subject: Social Science | **Test:** Test 3 (Day 21, 30 May 2026) — Weekly
Maximum Marks: 80

Syllabus: Civics — Federalism • Economics — Sectors of the Indian Economy • History — The Making of a Global World

SECTION A — Answer Key (1 mark each)

- Q1.** (b) Two or more levels of government.
- Q2.** (b) two-tier system of government — Union and State (third tier — local — added by 73rd/74th Amendments).
- Q3.** (b) Local self-government.
- Q4.** (c) both Union and State governments can legislate.
- Q5.** (a) Union List.
- Q6.** (b) tea plantation.
- Q7.** (c) sale of cloth in a shop.
- Q8.** (c) agriculture — many work but contribute little marginal output.
- Q9.** (b) 100 days.
- Q10.** (b) sold to final consumers.
- Q11.** (b) overland routes connecting Asia with Europe.
- Q12.** (c) a cattle plague — devastated cattle in Africa in the 1890s.
- Q13.** (c) 1944.
- Q14.** (b) 1846.
- Q15.** (c) bonded labour with a contract.
- Q16.** (c) India.
- Q17.** Organised sector — registered, regulated, with fixed working hours, leave, social security; unorganised sector — small, scattered, mostly outside government regulation, with no job security or benefits.
- Q18.** Gross Domestic Product — the value of all final goods and services produced within the country in a particular year.
- Q19.** Increased flows of trade, capital, labour, technology and ideas across countries — particularly between Europe, Asia, Africa and America after the 1830s.
- Q20.** English (continued as official language alongside Hindi).

SECTION B — Answer Key (2 marks each)

- Q21.** (i) Two or more levels of government, with each having its own jurisdiction in matters of legislation, taxation and administration. (ii) The constitution provides the basis for division of powers; courts settle disputes between centre and states. (2)
- Q22.** India is a federation with three tiers — Union, State and local government. The Constitution clearly divides subjects into Union, State and Concurrent Lists. Linguistic states were created in 1956. The 73rd and 74th amendments empowered local governments. The Election Commission and judiciary act as independent referees. (2)
- Q23.** Underemployment refers to a situation where people are working less than what their potential allows — they appear employed but are not fully productive. Example: in agriculture, five family members may work on a small farm where only two or three are needed; the rest are 'underemployed'. (2)
- Q24.** (i) Government investment in irrigation and rural infrastructure can create more on-farm and off-farm jobs. (ii) Promoting small-scale industries, dairy, food processing and tourism in rural areas; vocational training and credit for self-employment; effective implementation of MGNREGA. (2)

Q25. Three flows — of trade in goods, of labour (people in search of work) and of capital — connected continents at unprecedented levels. Improvements in transport (steam ships, railways) and communication (telegraph) along with industrialisation and colonialism, brought distant economies closer than ever before. (2)

SECTION C — Answer Key (3 marks each)

Q26. Decentralisation transfers power and responsibility to lower levels of government. The 73rd (Panchayati Raj) and 74th (Nagar Palikas) constitutional amendments mandated regular local elections, reservation of seats for SC/ST/OBC and women, devolution of subjects from State Lists, and creation of State Election Commissions and Finance Commissions. This brings government closer to the people, increases participation, addresses local needs, and strengthens federalism. (3)

Q27. Primary sector — provides natural products from the earth (agriculture, mining). Example: farming. **Secondary sector** — converts raw materials into finished goods (manufacturing). Example: textile mill. **Tertiary sector** — provides services to support primary and secondary, and to consumers. Example: banking, transport, retail. (3)

Q28. (i) Basic services like health, education and transport have expanded. (ii) Demand for services like trade, tourism, banking, communication, and IT has grown with rising income and urbanisation. (iii) Information and communication technology have created new types of services (call centres, software). Together these have made the tertiary sector the largest in terms of GDP contribution. (3)

Q29. (i) Indentured labourers were bound by a contract to work for an employer for a fixed number of years (usually 5) in return for passage to a foreign land and wages. (ii) Most were Indians from UP and Bihar, taken to plantations in the Caribbean (Trinidad, Guyana), Mauritius, Fiji. (iii) Working conditions were harsh — long hours, low pay, restricted movement; agents often misled labourers about distance and nature of work. (3)

Q30. India's exports and imports nearly halved between 1928 and 1934. Agricultural prices fell sharply (wheat prices fell by 50%), but rural taxes and rents remained unchanged, leading to widespread peasant distress. Many indebted farmers lost land. The Civil Disobedience Movement gathered momentum partly because of this economic distress. Indian industrialists, however, benefited as imports declined. (3)

Q31. (i) MGNREGA 2005 — guaranteed 100 days of wage employment per year per rural household. (ii) Various social security schemes (Atmanirbhar Bharat, Aam Aadmi Bima Yojana). (iii) Minimum wage laws and welfare boards for construction workers, head-load workers, hawkers. (iv) Skill development and credit through MUDRA, self-help groups. (3)

SECTION D — Answer Key (5 marks each)

Q32. Coming-together federations: independent states pool sovereignty into a federal entity for security and benefits — all units have equal status; centre tends to be weaker. Examples: USA, Switzerland, Australia. **Holding-together** federations: a large country divides power between central and state governments to accommodate diversity — the centre is more powerful, and constituent units may have unequal powers. Examples: India, Spain, Belgium. India is unique because some states (Jammu & Kashmir before 2019, North-Eastern States) had/have special arrangements. The constitution provides division of powers and an independent judiciary to settle disputes. (5)

Q33. Historically, the primary sector dominated production and employment. With industrialisation, the secondary sector became important; later, the tertiary sector overtook both in developed countries. In India today, the tertiary sector is the largest contributor to GDP (~55%), followed by secondary, and primary contributes the least to GDP (~15%). However, employment patterns lag behind: more than 40% of workers are still in agriculture. This means productivity (output per worker) is highest in services and lowest in agriculture. The implication: there is need to create more productive jobs in secondary and tertiary sectors and to shift workers out of agriculture. (5)

Q34. The First World War (1914-18) was the first 'modern industrial war' fought on an unprecedented scale. **World economy:** men and resources from across the world were mobilised; women entered factories. After the war Britain was burdened with debts; the US emerged as the largest economy and creditor; Europe declined. **India:** wartime demand boosted Indian industries (cotton textiles, jute) — they were freed from British competition. Indian industrialists made huge profits. But forced recruitment, increased taxes and price rises caused widespread hardship. The post-war years brought epidemics and famine, fuelling the nationalist

movement. (5)

Q35. The Bretton Woods system (1944) established the IMF and the World Bank to: (i) deal with foreign-exchange shortages, (ii) finance reconstruction and development. Currencies were pegged to the US dollar (which was tied to gold). It marked an era of unprecedented growth (1950s-60s) for Western economies and Japan, with stable exchange rates and full-employment policies. The system began to break down in the early 1970s when the US ended the dollar-gold convertibility (1971-73). The new phase of globalisation (post-1970s) is characterised by: floating exchange rates, large flows of capital across borders, MNCs relocating production to low-wage countries (China, India), and increased trade in services. (5)

SECTION E — Answer Key (4 marks each)

Q36. (i) Power is divided between a central authority and various constituent units (states), each having its own jurisdiction. (1) (ii) Union and State (with local self-government as the third tier). (1) (iii) The Constitution divides powers through three lists (Union, State, Concurrent), specifies the procedure for amendment requiring state-government consent, gives states their own legislatures and constitutions where applicable (J&K; earlier), and entrusts the judiciary to resolve disputes. (2)

Q37. (i) Workers employed outside the regulatory framework — small-scale enterprises, casual labourers, self-employed people, agricultural labourers — without job security, written contract or regular benefits. (1) (ii) Any two: low wages, long hours, no paid leave, no provident fund, no job security, exposure to occupational hazards. (1) (iii) Any two: extension of social security (PF, ESI, accident insurance) to unorganised workers; minimum wage enforcement; access to credit, training and welfare schemes (e.g. MGNREGA). (2)

Q38. (i) Any two of: steamships, railways, telegraph, refrigerated cargo, the opening of the Suez Canal (1869). (1) (ii) Food availability rose globally as production shifted to faraway regions (e.g. wheat from the American prairies, beef from Argentina, refrigerated meat from Australia/New Zealand) and was shipped cheaply to industrialising Europe. (1) (iii) Railways linked agricultural areas with ports for export, opened up new lands for cultivation, allowed bulk transport of food and raw materials, brought down transport costs, and integrated previously isolated economies into a global trading system. (2)

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